Teacher Wu Kuan | Midterm Must-Miss #2 — “Square Roots of 9” vs “√9”

English lecture notes · YouTube Short UKPuw0CLkz8

1. The trap question

What are the square roots of 9?

2. The method

• “Square roots of 9” = all numbers whose square is 9 → ±3.
• The symbol √9 means the principal (non-negative) root → 3.
• Square roots come in a ± pair; √ takes only the positive one.

3. Parent check method

Ask your child to answer two questions side by side: “square roots of 16?” and “√16?”

Practice

1. Find the square roots of 16.
2. Find √16.
3. Find the square roots of 0.25.
4. Find −√36.
5. Solve $x^2 = 81$.

Answers

1. ±4
2. 4
3. ±0.5
4. −6
5. x = ±9

Saber Math · Teacher Wu Kuan (YouTube: Saber Math) · Free first-week trial of Kuan Weekly practice (email sign-up): https://kuan-weekly.vercel.app/sample · More: https://kuanmath.vercel.app · SAT notes: DM IG @saber_math